

Wireframing

Part of **UI/UX Design Principles** · Estimated time: 40 min

Introduction

A wireframe is a rough sketch of a screen's layout — boxes for images, lines for text, no color or final type — meant to test structure before anyone invests time in visual polish.

Core ideas

- Low fidelity (pencil and paper, or simple boxes) is for testing layout ideas fast and cheap; it invites blunt feedback because nothing looks "finished" yet.
- Higher fidelity wireframes add more real structure (actual spacing, real content length) once the rough layout has been validated.
- Common elements to block out: navigation, primary content area, calls to action, and any repeating pattern like a card or list item.
- It's far cheaper to throw away and redo a five-minute sketch than a fully designed, polished screen.

Try it yourself

On paper or in any drawing tool, sketch three different layout ideas for a single screen (e.g. a recipe app's main page) in under five minutes each. Notice how much you can compare once none of them are precious.

Further reading

- Nielsen Norman Group — Wireframing 101

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/wireframing-101/>

- Figma — What is Wireframing?

<https://www.figma.com/resource-library/what-is-wireframing/>

ModuloTrainer reading material — return to the app to mark this module complete.